

Simple Past and Past Continuous Tense Practice

Middle (Classes 6-8) · English · CBSE · Simple past and past continuous tense

LEVEL 1 - SUPPORT

1. Fill in the blank with the correct past form of the verb: She ____ (go) to school yesterday.
2. Fill in the blank: They ____ (play) football last evening.
3. Choose the correct form: I (was/were) sleeping when he called.
4. Write the past tense of these verbs: eat, write, run.
5. Fill in the blank: He ____ (watch) TV at 8 pm last night. (use past continuous)

LEVEL 2 - ON LEVEL

1. Change into simple past tense: I visit my grandmother every week.
2. Fill in the blank using past continuous: While I ____ (read) a book, my sister was drawing.
3. Correct the error: She were eating dinner when the phone ring.
4. Combine using "when": (I was doing homework) + (my friend arrived)
5. Fill in the blanks: The children _ (play) in the park when it _ (start) to rain.

LEVEL 3 - CHALLENGE

1. Write a short paragraph of four sentences describing what you were doing yesterday at 6 pm, using both simple past and past continuous tense correctly.
2. Explain the difference in meaning between these two sentences:
 - a) I ate dinner when my mother called.
 - b) I was eating dinner when my mother called.
3. Rewrite the sentence correctly: Yesterday, while she was cooked dinner, the lights went off.
4. Complete the sentence with two different verb forms to show two different meanings:

While the teacher _ the lesson, the students _.
5. Identify and correct the tense errors in this sentence: When I was reach home, my brother was watch a movie and my mother cooked food.

ANSWER KEY

Level 1:

- 1) went
- 2) played
- 3) was
- 4) ate, wrote, ran
- 5) was watching

Level 2:

- 1) I visited my grandmother every week.
- 2) was reading
- 3) She was eating dinner when the phone rang.
- 4) I was doing my homework when my friend arrived.
- 5) were playing, started

Level 3:

- 1) Sample answer: Yesterday at 6 pm, I was doing my homework. My mother was cooking dinner in the kitchen. Suddenly, the lights went out. I lit a candle and continued my work.
- 2) In (a), the action of eating finished before the call (completed action). In (b), the eating was still happening when the call occurred (ongoing action interrupted).
- 3) Yesterday, while she was cooking dinner, the lights went off.
- 4) Sample: was explaining, were listening (or) explained, listened
- 5) Correct: When I reached home, my brother was watching a movie and my mother was cooking food.

AI can make mistakes — please review before using in class. Made with TeachSpark.